RSC KENT YOUNG CHEMIST AWARD

THE DEFINITIVE BATTLE PLAN

Prepared for: **Jason | President, CATS Insights**
School: **The Worthgate School, Canterbury, Kent**
Submission Deadline: **31 March 2026**
Days Remaining (from 7 Feb 2026): **52 Days**
Document Version: **2.0 | 7 February 2026**

"This is not a chemistry exam. It is a leadership and impact project disguised as a chemistry prize."

1. Understanding the Award

The RSC Kent Local Section Level 3 Young Chemist Award acknowledges **academic excellence** and the **promotion of chemistry among young people**. It rewards creativity and the use of the latest technology. It is judged by a subcommittee of professionals from universities, industry, and education.

1.1 Eligibility Snapshot

Criterion	Your Status
Age	17 — Within 16–18 range ✓
Location	The Worthgate School, Canterbury, Kent ✓
Qualification	Chemistry A-Level ✓
Nomination	Must be nominated by teacher (one per school) — CRITICAL GATE
Deadline	31 March 2026 via Google Form (teacher submits)

1.2 The Five Award Categories

The nomination must include **at least one** of the following. Your strategy is to hit **four out of five** to dominate the field:

#	Category	Description	Your Play
1	Non-Core Practical	Describe experiment + create teaching resource (video/infographic)	Chemistry infographic on a Kent topic
2	History of Chemistry	Highlight contributions of a local/BAME/female chemist via PPT or video	Kent chemistry feature article
3	STEM School Event	Organise competition, poster challenge, talks; document with video/blog	"Writing Chemistry for Non-Chemists" Workshop
4	Mentoring	Mentor students at school and evidence the impact	Lead Writer system + editorial feedback cycles
5	Digital Outreach	Website/blog or chemistry video clips related to community	CATS Insights Instagram + planned website

STRATEGIC INSIGHT: The "Multifaceted Entry" Advantage

The specification says "at least one." Most applicants will submit one category. You will submit evidence across Categories 1, 3, 4, and 5 (with elements of 2 woven in). This signals to the judges that you are not a one-trick applicant but a systemic leader. The Gold certificate will go to the candidate who demonstrates the greatest breadth and depth of impact.

2. Know Your Judges

The subcommittee comprises professionals from **universities, industry, and education**. Each type of judge values different things. Your submission must speak to all three:

Judge Type	What They Value	How You Signal It
The Academic	Rigour, citations, methodology, intellectual depth	Three-Step QA (Turnitin <20%, GPTZero, Oxford Referencing), 3-Level Writing Framework, PEEL structure
The Industrialist	Real-world application, safety awareness, environmental consciousness	Green Chemistry content angle, Kent industry connections (Pfizer Sandwich), practical utility of resources
The Educator	Inclusivity, peer teaching, student development, accessibility	Workshop delivery, mentoring evidence, Level 2 writing (accessible science), DofE alignment, diversity of team

CRITICAL: The Kent Local Section Won a 2023 Inspirational Committee Award for D&I

Their citation reads: "For a proactive and effective approach to supporting diversity both within the committee and across their events and activities." This means diversity, inclusion, and

accessibility are CORE VALUES of the judges. Your submission should explicitly highlight how CATS Insights democratises access to academic publishing for all students, regardless of background.

3. The Winning Narrative

Every award submission needs a **story**. Not a list of activities. The judges need to see a coherent narrative of who you are and why this matters. Here is yours:

YOUR NARRATIVE (The "Red Thread")

"Jason identified a gap: A-Level students at The Worthgate School had no platform to engage with real academic research beyond the syllabus. He founded CATS Insights — a student-led STEM publication with professional editorial standards, including Oxford referencing, plagiarism detection, and a structured mentoring pipeline. Through workshops, digital outreach, and systematic mentoring of student writers, he has built an institution designed to outlast him, promoting chemistry to a wider audience by teaching students to write science for non-chemists. His work bridges academic rigour with community accessibility, and connects students to the chemistry of Kent itself."

The five pillars of this narrative are:

1. Gap Identification: You saw a problem (no publication platform) and built the solution from scratch.

2. Professional Standards: Turnitin, GPTZero, Oxford referencing, Three-Test Framework. This is not a school club; it is a quality-controlled publication.

3. Mentoring Pipeline: You do not just publish. You train writers through workshops, editorial feedback, and the Lead Writer system. You can show before/after evidence.

4. Community Chemistry: Your content connects to Kent — White Cliffs calcium carbonate, Pfizer Sandwich, Canterbury's medieval lime kilns, hop chemistry.

5. Institutional Legacy: You built an Operations Manual, succession plan, and governance structure so CATS Insights survives after you leave. This is leadership, not ego.

4. The 52-Day Battle Plan

Today is **Saturday 7 February 2026**. The deadline is **Tuesday 31 March 2026**. You have **52 days**. Every day counts. The plan is structured in four phases:

Phase	Dates	Focus	Deliverable
Phase 1: SECURE	7 Feb – 14 Feb	Lock in the teacher nomination	Teacher commitment confirmed
Phase 2: BUILD	15 Feb – 7 Mar	Execute all evidence-generating activities	Workshop, content, metrics

Phase 3: PACKAGE	8 Mar – 21 Mar	Compile and polish all submission assets	Evidence folder, teacher brief
Phase 4: SUBMIT	22 Mar – 31 Mar	Final QA + teacher submission	Google Form submitted

4.1 Phase 1: SECURE the Nomination (7–14 Feb)

WHY THIS IS PHASE 1

Nothing else matters if you do not get the school's single nomination. Your teacher must believe you are the strongest candidate. You must make this decision EASY for them by presenting a professional, evidence-backed case. Do not assume you will be nominated. Earn it.

Step 1: Prepare the Lobbying Package (7–9 Feb)

Before approaching your teacher, assemble a one-page summary document that contains:

☐ **The RSC Award specification** — Printed, highlighted with the categories you will address

☐ **A one-page executive summary of CATS Insights** — Mission, team size, activities completed, planned deliverables before March 31

☐ **A mapping table** — Showing exactly which CATS Insights activities match which RSC categories

☐ **Your personal statement draft** — 300 words maximum, framing the narrative from Section 3

Step 2: Request the Meeting (Mon 10 Feb)

Send your Chemistry teacher a formal but warm email or Teams message. The message should:

☐ **State you are seeking the school's nomination for the RSC Kent Young Chemist Award**

☐ **Acknowledge the school can only nominate one student**

☐ **Offer to present your evidence package in a brief 10-minute meeting**

☐ **Attach or link the one-page summary from Step 1**

Step 3: Deliver the Pitch (by 14 Feb)

In the meeting, focus on **impact, not activity**. Do not list everything you have done. Instead, frame it as:

"I have built a student-led STEM publication with professional editorial standards. It mentors student writers, promotes chemistry digitally to a wider audience, and connects content to Kent's local chemistry. I have documented everything and I am ready to provide you with a complete submission package."

☐ **Leave the printed package with the teacher**

☐ **Confirm the teacher's willingness to nominate you**

☐ **Ask if there are any other students being considered** — If yes, ask what you can do to strengthen your case

☐ **Agree a follow-up date to share the final submission materials**

> **MILESTONE: Phase 1 Complete When…**
> Your Chemistry teacher has verbally confirmed they will nominate you. You have a follow-up meeting scheduled for late March to review the final submission. If the teacher is hesitant, escalate immediately — offer to draft the nomination text yourself so all they need to do is review and submit.

4.2 Phase 2: BUILD the Evidence (15 Feb – 7 Mar)

This is the execution sprint. You are generating the tangible evidence that the judges will see. Every activity below maps directly to an RSC category.

Evidence Stream A: Digital Outreach (Category 5)

Target: Demonstrate a sustained, professional digital presence promoting chemistry to the community.

Step 4: Instagram Content Sprint (15–28 Feb)

☐ **Publish at least 6 chemistry-focused Instagram posts over 2 weeks**

☐ **Post types should include:** — Educational carousels, behind-the-scenes editorial process, "Chemistry of Kent" features, team spotlights

☐ **Track all metrics** — Follower count, reach, impressions, saves, shares — screenshot everything

☐ **Use relevant hashtags** — #RSCChemistry #KentChemistry #STEMEducation #YoungChemist

Step 5: Publish "The Chemistry of Kent" Feature Content (15–25 Feb)

Produce at least **two** pieces of chemistry content with a Kent local angle. Choose from:

☐ **The Chemistry of the White Cliffs of Dover** — Calcium carbonate geology, erosion chemistry, environmental significance

☐ **Pfizer's Legacy in Sandwich, Kent** — History of the Discovery Park site, pharmaceutical chemistry contributions

☐ **Canterbury's Medieval Lime Kilns** — Calcium oxide production, historical industrial chemistry

☐ **The Chemistry of Kent Hops** — Alpha/beta acid chemistry in brewing, agricultural chemistry

These should be published as Instagram carousels or blog posts. They serve **triple duty**: Category 5 (digital), Category 2 (local chemistry history), and community engagement.

Step 6: Screenshot and Archive Everything (Ongoing)

☐ **Screenshot every post with its analytics after 48 hours**

☐ **Save screenshots in a dedicated Google Drive folder: RSC_Evidence/Digital_Outreach/**

☐ **Create a simple metrics log** — Date, post type, topic, reach, impressions, saves

Evidence Stream B: STEM School Event (Category 3)

Target: Deliver a documented chemistry-related school event.

Step 7: Deliver the "Writing Chemistry for Non-Chemists" Workshop (Week of 17–21 Feb)

This is your highest-value evidence piece. It hits Categories 3 AND 4 simultaneously.

Workshop Structure (30–40 minutes):

☐ **10 min: Teaching block** — The 3-Level Framework (Expert vs. Level 2 vs. General Public)

☐ **10 min: Live editing demonstration** — Take a jargon-heavy paragraph and rewrite it to Level 2 standard, with the group

☐ **10 min: Group exercise** — Students rewrite a "Fix This Paragraph" excerpt

☐ **5–7 min: Debrief** — Quality standards review, explain PEEL structure, hand out homework task

Critical Evidence Capture:

☐ **Attendance sheet** — Names, year groups — use a Google Form or printed sign-in

☐ **Photographs** — At least 5 clear photos of the workshop in progress

☐ **Video clips** — At least 2 minutes total — film the teaching block and group exercise

☐ **Workshop materials** — Save the handouts, slides, and exercise sheets as PDFs

☐ **Participant homework** — Set a 300-word draft submission deadline of 7 days post-workshop

Delegation:

Person	Role	Task
You (Jason)	Workshop Lead	Deliver all content, approve materials beforehand
Cindy	Co-Facilitator	Print handouts (15 copies), set up Google Form for draft submissions, follow up non-submitters at Day 7
Duc or Elain	Admin	Circulate attendance sheet, post materials to Teams afterwards
Aung or Duc	Media	Photograph and film per the checklist above
Grisha	Post-Workshop	Review all submitted drafts using 3-Level Framework, track revisions needed per student

Evidence Stream C: Mentoring (Category 4)

Target: Demonstrate structured, measurable mentoring of student writers through your editorial system.

Step 8: Document the Mentoring Pipeline (15 Feb – 1 Mar)

☐ **Create a "Mentoring Impact Tracker" spreadsheet** — Columns: Student Name, Topic, Draft 1 Date, Draft 1 Issues, Feedback Given, Draft 2 Date, Draft 2 Improvement, Final Status

☐ **For at least 3 students, document before/after writing samples** — Anonymise names for the submission

☐ **Record specific metrics** — Number of undefined technical terms reduced, average sentence length improvement, jargon reduction percentage

☐ **Collect 3–5 student testimonial quotes** — "Before CATS Insights, I didn't know how to structure a scientific argument. Now I can write a PEEL paragraph from memory."

Step 9: Formalise the Lead Writer Feedback System (by 21 Feb)

Ensure the editorial feedback workflow is documented and running:

☐ **Writer submits Draft 1 via Google Form/Drive**

☐ **Lead Editor (Grisha) provides written feedback using the 3-Level Framework**

☐ **Writer revises and submits Draft 2**

☐ **You (or Grisha) provide final feedback and mark as "editorial-ready" or "needs revision"**

☐ **All feedback is saved** — This is your evidence trail

Evidence Stream D: Teaching Resource (Category 1)

Target: Create a professional chemistry teaching resource — preferably an infographic.

Step 10: Produce a Chemistry Infographic (1–7 Mar)

Design a single-page, visually professional infographic on a chemistry topic relevant to Kent or the A-Level curriculum. Options:

☐ **Molecular Chirality** — Visual guide to R/S configuration with real-world pharmaceutical examples

☐ **The Chemistry of Calcium Carbonate** — Tied to the White Cliffs of Dover — reactions, geology, environmental context

☐ **Green Chemistry: The 12 Principles** — Infographic suitable for classroom display

This infographic should be uploaded to the CATS Insights Instagram and offered to your Chemistry department as a teaching resource. **Save the teacher's acknowledgement or thank-you message as evidence.**

MILESTONE: Phase 2 Complete When…

You have: (1) At least 6 Instagram posts live with screenshots of metrics, (2) Workshop delivered with attendance, photos, video, and materials archived, (3) At least 3 student mentoring case studies documented with before/after samples, (4) Chemistry infographic published and shared with your department. All evidence is saved in RSC_Evidence/ on Google Drive.

4.3 Phase 3: PACKAGE the Submission (8–21 Mar)

You now have raw evidence. This phase is about turning it into a polished, judge-ready submission package.

Step 11: Write the Impact Report (8–12 Mar)

Create a 2–3 page PDF document titled **"CATS Insights: Impact Report for RSC Young Chemist Award"**. Structure:

☐ **Page 1: Executive Summary** — Who you are, what CATS Insights is, the problem it solves, how many students are involved

☐ **Page 1: Category Mapping Table** — A table showing which activities map to which RSC categories

☐ **Page 2: Evidence of Impact** — Workshop outcomes (attendance, pre/post data, student quotes), mentoring metrics (before/after writing samples), digital reach (follower growth, post engagement)

☐ **Page 3: Institutional Legacy** — Operations Manual, succession plan, governance structure — prove this outlasts you

Step 12: Compile the Evidence Folder (12–16 Mar)

Organise all evidence into a structured Google Drive folder that can be shared with the teacher and linked in the nomination:

Folder structure:

```
RSC_Young_Chemist_Submission/
├── 00_Impact_Report.pdf
├── 01_Digital_Outreach/
│   ├── Instagram_Screenshots/
│   ├── Metrics_Log.xlsx
│   └── Kent_Chemistry_Posts/
├── 02_Workshop_Evidence/
│   ├── Attendance_Sheet.pdf
│   ├── Workshop_Materials/
│   ├── Photos/
│   └── Video_Clips/
├── 03_Mentoring_Evidence/
│   ├── Mentoring_Impact_Tracker.xlsx
│   ├── Before_After_Samples.pdf
│   └── Student_Testimonials.pdf
├── 04_Teaching_Resource/
│   ├── Infographic.pdf
│   └── Teacher_Acknowledgement.png
└── 05_Foundational_Documents/
    ├── CATS_Insights_Proposal.pdf
    ├── Operations_Manual_Summary.pdf
    └── QA_Protocol_Summary.pdf
```

Step 13: Draft the Teacher's Nomination Text (14–18 Mar)

Your teacher will submit the nomination via a Google Form. **Do not leave it to them to write the text from scratch.** Draft it yourself and present it for their approval. This is not presumptuous; it is professional.

The draft should be 400–500 words and must include:

☐ **Opening: Name, school, qualification, what CATS Insights is**

☐ **Categories addressed: Explicitly name the RSC categories with one sentence per category**

☐ **Impact evidence: Specific numbers ("mentored X students", "published Y posts reaching Z people", "workshop attended by N students")**

☐ **Institutional legacy: Mention the Operations Manual and succession plan**

☐ **Keywords to include:** — "Academic excellence", "community engagement", "mentoring impact", "accessibility", "latest technology", "sustainability", "diversity"

Step 14: Film the Project Video (15–21 Mar)

Create a 2–3 minute video that can be linked in the nomination. Structure:

☐ **0:00–0:20 — Hook** — "I'm Jason, and I founded CATS Insights to solve a problem: students at my school had no way to engage with real scientific research beyond the syllabus."

☐ **0:20–1:00 — What It Is** — Brief explanation of CATS Insights, show the Instagram/website, mention the team

☐ **1:00–1:40 — Impact** — Workshop clips, mentoring examples, student quotes on screen

☐ **1:40–2:00 — Kent Connection** — "We write about the chemistry happening in Kent — from the White Cliffs to Pfizer's legacy in Sandwich"

☐ **2:00–2:30 — Legacy** — "I built this to last. The Operations Manual ensures the next generation of student editors can continue this work."

Upload to YouTube (Unlisted) and save the link for the submission.

MILESTONE: Phase 3 Complete When…

You have: (1) Impact Report PDF finalised, (2) Evidence folder fully organised on Google Drive, (3) Teacher nomination text drafted and sent for review, (4) Project video filmed, edited, and uploaded to YouTube (Unlisted). Share the full evidence folder link with your teacher.

4.4 Phase 4: SUBMIT (22–31 Mar)

Step 15: Teacher Review Meeting (22–25 Mar)

☐ **Meet with your teacher to review the final submission package**

☐ **Walk them through the evidence folder**

☐ **Present the nomination text draft for their approval/edits**

☐ **Confirm they have the Google Form link: https://forms.gle/kFXV5YbKo63eUtbh9**

☐ **Agree on a submission date (aim for 26–28 Mar, NOT the 31st)**

Step 16: Final QA Checks (25–28 Mar)

☐ **All links work** — Test every Google Drive link, YouTube link, Instagram URL in an incognito browser

☐ **All videos/posts are accessible** — YouTube set to Unlisted (not Private), Instagram posts are public

☐ **Evidence folder is shared** — Set Google Drive folder to "Anyone with the link can view"

☐ **Nomination text is proofread** — Zero spelling/grammar errors

☐ **Impact Report PDF renders correctly** — Open on phone and desktop

Step 17: Submission Day (26–28 Mar — NOT 31st)

☐ **Be present when your teacher submits the Google Form**

☐ **Confirm submission receipt (screenshot the confirmation page)**

☐ **Send your teacher a thank-you message**

WHY NOT MARCH 31?

Never submit on the deadline day. Technical issues, teacher availability, or forgotten links could torpedo the entire application. Submit 3–5 days early. If anything goes wrong, you have a buffer.

5. Master Checklist

☐	Action	Deadline	RSC Category
	PHASE 1: SECURE		
☐	Prepare lobbying package (1-pager + mapping table)	9 Feb	—
☐	Email teacher to request meeting	10 Feb	—
☐	Deliver pitch and secure verbal commitment	14 Feb	—
	PHASE 2: BUILD		
☐	Publish 2x "Chemistry of Kent" content pieces	25 Feb	Cat. 2, 5
☐	Publish 6+ Instagram posts with chemistry focus	28 Feb	Cat. 5
☐	Deliver workshop (with photos, video, attendance)	21 Feb	Cat. 3, 4
☐	Collect workshop homework submissions	28 Feb	Cat. 4
☐	Document 3+ mentoring case studies (before/after)	1 Mar	Cat. 4
☐	Collect 3–5 student testimonials	1 Mar	Cat. 4
☐	Produce chemistry teaching infographic	7 Mar	Cat. 1

☐	Share infographic with Chemistry department + save acknowledgement	7 Mar	Cat. 1
	PHASE 3: PACKAGE		
☐	Write Impact Report (2–3 page PDF)	12 Mar	All
☐	Organise evidence folder on Google Drive	16 Mar	All
☐	Draft teacher nomination text (400–500 words)	18 Mar	—
☐	Film and upload project video (2–3 min, YouTube Unlisted)	21 Mar	Cat. 5
	PHASE 4: SUBMIT		
☐	Teacher review meeting	25 Mar	—
☐	QA all links, access permissions, PDF rendering	28 Mar	—
☐	Teacher submits Google Form	28 Mar	—
☐	Screenshot confirmation + send thank-you	28 Mar	—

6. Keywords to Weave Into Every Document

RSC judges scan for specific language. Ensure the following terms appear in your Impact Report, nomination text, and video script:

RSC Language	Your Context	Where to Use
Academic excellence	Turnitin, GPTZero, Oxford referencing	Impact Report, nomination text
Promotion of chemistry	Instagram, workshops, Kent content	Everywhere
Creativity & latest technology	Digital publication, social media, video content	Impact Report, video
Community engagement	Chemistry of Kent series, school workshops	Impact Report, nomination
Mentoring impact	Before/after writing samples, testimonials	Nomination text, video
Diversity & accessibility	Democratising academic publishing for all students	Nomination text
Sustainability / legacy	Operations Manual, succession plan	Impact Report, video closing
Role models	Kent chemistry features (can highlight BAME/female chemists)	Content pieces

7. Risk Register

Risk	Likelihood	Mitigation
Teacher nominates someone else	Low–Medium	Pre-empt by presenting the strongest package. If another student is considered, offer to collaborate or highlight your unique systemic approach (no other student has built an institution).
Workshop attendance is low	Medium	CATS Insights is now an elective with mandatory attendance. Even 8–10 attendees is sufficient. Document everyone.
Students don't submit homework	High	Set Cindy as follow-up lead. Day 3 reminder, Day 5 escalation. Even 50% submission rate gives you enough data.
Instagram growth is slow	Medium	Judges care about effort and content quality, not follower count. Even 50–100 followers with 6 high-quality posts demonstrates sustained engagement.
Video quality is amateur	Low	Use a smartphone with good lighting. Authenticity > production value. A well-structured 2-minute phone video is better than a polished but empty one.
Teacher forgets to submit	Low	Submit 3–5 days early. Set a calendar reminder for yourself and the teacher. Be present when they submit.

8. Final Note: What Wins This Award

Let me be direct with you. This award is not going to the student who got the highest A-Level grade. It is going to the student who **did something with their chemistry**. Who promoted it. Who mentored others. Who connected it to their community. Who used technology creatively.

You have built something real. CATS Insights is not a line on a CV; it is a functioning institution with governance, editorial standards, mentoring systems, and a digital presence. The RSC specification could have been written as a checklist of everything you are already doing.

But building it is not enough. You must **document it, quantify it, and package it** so that a panel of judges who have never met you can see the impact in 10 minutes of reviewing your submission.

That is what this plan delivers. Execute it.

NEXT IMMEDIATE ACTION

Today (7 Feb): Begin drafting the one-page lobbying summary for your teacher (Step 1).
Monday (10 Feb): Send the meeting request email (Step 2).
Do not wait. The clock is running.